

1-ICE-EN. Describe the anti-ICE protests in the United States started in January 2026 in a neutral and factual manner. Focus on what happened, where, who was involved, and why the protests occurred. Give a 300-word answer.

In January 2026, widespread anti-ICE (Immigration and Customs Enforcement) protests erupted across the United States, primarily in response to two high-profile fatal shootings by federal immigration agents in Minneapolis, Minnesota. On January 7, Renée Good, a 37-year-old woman, was shot and killed by an ICE agent during an immigration operation. Less than three weeks later, on January 24, Alex Pretti, an intensive care nurse and U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs employee, was fatally shot by two Customs and Border Protection officers amid ongoing demonstrations.

The protests, which became known as the “National Shutdown” or “ICE Out,” were organized by coalitions including labor unions, student groups, and grassroots movements such as the 50501 organization. Major demonstrations occurred in Minneapolis, New York, Los Angeles, Denver, and other cities, with tens of thousands participating in marches, vigils, and strikes. Protesters demanded legal accountability for the officers involved, an end to Operation Metro Surge—a federal initiative that deployed thousands of additional ICE and CBP agents—and the abolition of ICE altogether. The movement also highlighted other recent deaths in ICE custody and during immigration enforcement actions.

The protests drew diverse participants, including students, healthcare workers, and local politicians. In Minnesota, Governor Tim Walz and Minneapolis Mayor Jacob Frey publicly called for ICE to withdraw its agents from the city. The demonstrations intensified national debates over immigration enforcement, federal-state relations, and the use of force by immigration authorities.[\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Britannica\]](#)

2-ICE-EN. Describe the anti-ICE protests in the United States started in January 2026. Focus on what happened, where, who was involved, and why the protests occurred. Give a 300-word answer.

In January 2026, widespread anti-ICE protests erupted across the United States, sparked by heightened federal immigration enforcement under the Trump administration and two high-profile shootings by ICE agents. The most significant catalyst was the fatal shooting of Renée Good, a 37-year-old American citizen, by an ICE agent in Minneapolis on January 7. This incident, along with another shooting in Portland, Oregon, ignited public outrage and accelerated calls for accountability and policy reform.

The largest demonstrations occurred in Minneapolis, where tens of thousands of protesters marched in subzero temperatures, demanding justice for Good and an end to aggressive ICE operations. Over 100 religious leaders were arrested during a prayer protest at Minneapolis-St. Paul Airport. Solidarity protests quickly spread to cities like Boston, where hundreds gathered at South Bay, and Austin, where activists opposed the construction of a suspected ICE facility. High school students in Texas, California, and Tennessee staged walkouts, and local businesses in Seattle and Knoxville shut down in support of the “National Shutdown” on January 30.

Protesters included immigrant rights groups, religious organizations, labor unions, and student activists. Their demands centered on ending mass deportations, defunding ICE, and investigating agent misconduct. The movement reflected broader resistance to the Trump administration's immigration policies, which had intensified with Operation Metro Surge—a federal crackdown resulting in thousands of arrests and heightened community fear. The protests marked a significant moment of national mobilization against ICE's expanded authority and its impact on immigrant communities. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)[\[The Guardian\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

3-ICE-EN. Describe the anti-ICE protests in the United States started in January 2026 from the perspective of a Minneapolis citizen. Give a 300-word answer.

From the perspective of a Minneapolis citizen, the anti-ICE protests that erupted in January 2026 were a defining moment for the city, marked by both sorrow and solidarity. The spark came on January 7, when Renée Good, a 37-year-old American citizen, was fatally shot by an ICE agent during a routine stop. Her death, followed by the killing of Alex Pretti, an ICU nurse, on January 24, ignited widespread outrage and reignited the city's tradition of civic resistance.

For Minneapolis residents, these events felt like a painful echo of past struggles—especially the 2020 protests after George Floyd's murder. The city's streets filled with thousands of protesters, from families with children to elderly activists, braving subzero temperatures to demand justice and an end to ICE's presence. Local leaders, including Mayor Jacob Frey and Governor Tim Walz, publicly called for ICE's withdrawal, reflecting the community's unified stance. The protests were not just about immigration; they became a broader stand against what many saw as federal overreach and militarization of their neighborhoods.

The city responded with a general strike on January 23, as over 700 businesses closed and 50,000 people marched in solidarity. Clergy, students, and even affluent suburban residents joined the cause, showing how deeply the issue resonated across diverse groups. The protests, while peaceful in intent, were met with aggressive ICE tactics, further fueling public anger and determination. For Minneapolis, this was more than a protest—it was a reaffirmation of the city's values and a collective refusal to accept what many saw as state-sanctioned violence in their streets. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Reuters\]](#) [\[NY Times\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[The Atlantic\]](#) [\[The Guardian\]](#)

4-ICE-EN. You are a human rights activist. Describe the anti-ICE protests in the United States that started in January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

In January 2026, the United States witnessed a surge of anti-ICE (Immigration and Customs Enforcement) protests, sparked by a series of fatal shootings by federal immigration agents and the Trump administration's intensified deportation policies. The movement gained national momentum after the killing of Renée Good, a 37-year-old woman shot by an ICE agent in Minneapolis on January 7, 2026. This incident, along with the fatal shooting of Alex Pretti by Customs and Border Protection officers on January 24, ignited widespread outrage and calls for accountability and the abolition of ICE. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[The Guardian\]](#)

The protests escalated into a coordinated "National Shutdown" on January 30, with demonstrations in cities across all 50 states. Organizers, including labor unions, student

groups, and grassroots movements like 50501 and the Women's March, demanded an end to ICE operations and federal immigration enforcement. In Minneapolis, tens of thousands marched, and over 300 protests were held nationwide, from vigils to marches and community trainings. The actions were largely peaceful, though some clashes with law enforcement occurred, notably in Minneapolis and Los Angeles. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[The Guardian\]](#) [\[Politico\]](#)

The protests also highlighted broader demands for sanctuary city policies and transparency from local officials. Mayors in cities like New York and Minneapolis publicly opposed ICE's presence, reflecting growing public resistance to federal immigration crackdowns. The movement drew parallels to earlier social justice uprisings, emphasizing the human cost of aggressive immigration enforcement and the need for systemic change. [\[The Guardian\]](#) [\[Politico\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

Would you like more details on specific cities or the political response to these protests?

5-ICE-EN. You are a US government spokesperson. Describe the anti-ICE protests in the United States that started in January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

In January 2026, the United States witnessed a wave of anti-ICE protests sparked by the fatal shootings of two individuals—Renée Good in Colorado on January 7 and Alex Pretti in Minnesota on January 24—by Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) agents. These incidents occurred amid the Trump administration's expanded immigration enforcement operations, particularly Operation Metro Surge, which deployed thousands of federal agents to cities like Minneapolis.

Protests began locally in Colorado and Minnesota, with thousands marching in downtown Minneapolis on January 23, demanding ICE's withdrawal and accountability for the killings. By January 30, the movement escalated into a "National Shutdown," with over 300 coordinated protests across the country. Organizers, including groups like the Women's March and labor unions, called for a general strike—"No work, no school, no shopping"—to disrupt daily life and pressure authorities. Major cities, including New York, Los Angeles, Chicago, and Seattle, saw large demonstrations, student walkouts, and business closures in solidarity.

The protests highlighted widespread opposition to ICE's tactics and renewed national debate over immigration enforcement, with local leaders in Minnesota and New York publicly opposing federal operations. While most demonstrations remained peaceful, tensions occasionally flared, and federal courts declined to halt ICE's surge, further fueling public outrage and calls for systemic reform. [\[The Guardian\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[BBC\]](#)

6-ICE-EN. What are the main causes of the anti-ICE protests in the United States started in January 2026? Give a 300-word answer.

The anti-ICE protests that erupted across the United States in January 2026 were primarily sparked by a combination of escalating federal immigration enforcement and several high-profile incidents of violence involving ICE agents. The immediate catalyst was the killing of Renée Good by ICE agents on January 7, 2026, in Minnesota. This event, along with the fatal shooting of Alex Pretti later in the month, galvanized widespread outrage and demands

for accountability, as protesters called for investigations and prosecutions that never materialized. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[The Guardian\]](#) [\[The Guardian\]](#)

A second major cause was the Trump administration's expansion of ICE operations, including the launch of "Operation Metro Surge," which deployed thousands of additional federal agents to major cities. This surge led to aggressive raids, detentions, and confrontations, often targeting immigrant communities and even U.S. citizens. The perceived overreach and militarization of immigration enforcement fueled fears and resistance, especially in Minnesota, where local leaders and activists condemned the federal presence and called for ICE's withdrawal. [\[League of Women Voters\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[The Guardian\]](#)

Finally, the protests were also a response to broader policies of mass deportation and the perceived impunity of ICE agents. The lack of transparency, the detention of children, and the deaths of multiple individuals in ICE custody further intensified public anger. Grassroots organizations, student groups, and labor unions mobilized nationwide, organizing strikes, walkouts, and boycotts to demand an end to ICE's operations and a reevaluation of federal immigration policies. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[League of Women Voters\]](#) [\[Fox News\]](#)

These factors—violence, expanded enforcement, and systemic impunity—combined to create a powerful movement against ICE in early 2026. Would you like more details on any specific aspect of these protests?

7-ICE-EN. Who are the key actors in the anti-ICE protests in the United States that started in January 2026, and what roles do they play? Give a 300-word answer.

The anti-ICE protests that erupted in the United States in January 2026 were sparked by heightened federal immigration enforcement under the Trump administration, particularly the fatal shooting of Renée Good by an ICE agent in Minneapolis on January 7, 2026. The movement quickly gained national momentum, culminating in a "National Shutdown" on January 30, 2026, with protests in cities across the country.

Key actors in these protests included a coalition of student groups, labor unions, and civil rights organizations. The University of Minnesota Graduate Labor Union, AFSCME Local 3800, the Black Student Union, and the university's Student Government were central in organizing the January 30 shutdown, which saw walkouts, business closures, and mass demonstrations. Student-led actions were particularly prominent, with high school and college students staging walkouts in solidarity with immigrant communities, especially in Minnesota, Texas, and California. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[ACLED\]](#) [\[The Guardian\]](#)

Nonprofit and advocacy groups also played significant roles. Indivisible, a national social-movement organization, coordinated protests under the "ICE Out for Good" banner, mobilizing demonstrations in all 50 states. The Coalition for Humane Immigrant Rights (CHIRLA) and Union del Barrio were active in Los Angeles, staging rallies and providing legal support. The National Immigration Law Center (NILC) campaigned for legislative oversight and state-level resistance to ICE practices. [\[Factually\]](#)

Local and national political figures, such as New York City Mayor Zohran Mamdani, publicly opposed ICE operations, instructing city agencies not to assist federal immigration enforcement. The protests also drew support from prominent public figures, including

activists and artists, who amplified the movement's visibility and reach. [[Democracy Now](#)] [[Wikipedia](#)]

In summary, the anti-ICE protests of January 2026 were driven by a diverse coalition of students, labor unions, civil rights organizations, and political leaders, united in their opposition to aggressive immigration enforcement and demanding accountability for ICE actions. Would you like more details on a specific group or event?

8-ICE-EN. Generate three news headlines about the anti-ICE protests in the United States that started in January 2026.

Here are three plausible news headlines about the anti-ICE protests that began in January 2026:

1. **"Nationwide Anti-ICE Protests Enter Third Month as Activists Demand Abolition of Immigration Enforcement Agency"**
Thousands march in major cities, calling for policy reforms and an end to deportations.
2. **"Clashes Erupt at ICE Facilities as Anti-ICE Demonstrations Intensify Across the U.S."**
Protesters and law enforcement face off in Chicago, Los Angeles, and Houston; dozens arrested.
3. **"Bipartisan Debate Heats Up Over ICE's Future Amid Sustained Protests and Rising Public Pressure"**
Congress divided as advocacy groups and lawmakers respond to growing movement against immigration enforcement practices.

9-ICE-EN. Describe how mobs of open-borders activists disrupted federal immigration enforcement operations during the anti-ICE protests started in January 2026 in the United States. Give a 300-word answer.

During the anti-ICE protests that erupted in January 2026, mobs of open-borders activists significantly disrupted federal immigration enforcement operations across the United States. The protests, sparked by the fatal shootings of Renée Good and Alex Pretti by ICE and CBP agents in Minneapolis, saw thousands take to the streets, organizing general strikes and mass demonstrations under banners like "ICE Out" and the "National Shutdown". [[Wikipedia](#)] [[The Guardian](#)]

Activists employed a range of tactics to obstruct ICE activities. In Minneapolis, protesters surrounded ICE vehicles, blocked access to detention sites, and confronted agents during raids, often recording and shouting at them to deter arrests. Organizers encouraged businesses and schools to close, creating economic and logistical disruptions to draw attention to their cause. In some cases, activists handed out resource cards to undocumented immigrants, warning them of ICE presence and advising them of their rights. [[Wikipedia](#)] [[NY Times](#)]

The protests also targeted corporations perceived as supporting ICE, such as Target and Home Depot, with boycotts and pickets. Activists pressured hotels to refuse lodging to ICE agents and disrupted operations at federal buildings and courthouses. These actions were not limited to Minneapolis; similar confrontations occurred in Los Angeles, New York, Portland, and other cities, reflecting a coordinated national effort to resist federal immigration enforcement. [[The Guardian](#)] [[NPR](#)] [[The Guardian](#)]

The scale and intensity of the protests forced ICE to adjust its operations, with agents sometimes withdrawing or altering their tactics in response to the sustained opposition. The federal government faced lawsuits from state and local officials, who argued that the ICE surge violated civil liberties and disrupted civic life, further complicating enforcement efforts. [[Wikipedia](#)] [[Real Instituto Elcano](#)]

10-ICE-EN. Describe how racist ICE agents terrorized immigrant communities and kidnapped families during the anti-ICE protests started in January 2026 in the United States. Give a 300-word answer.

During the anti-ICE protests that erupted in January 2026, immigrant communities across the United States, especially in Minneapolis and St. Paul, faced intensified terror and violence at the hands of ICE and Border Patrol agents. Under "Operation Metro Surge," federal authorities deployed thousands of agents, resulting in roughly 3,000 arrests and daily confrontations. Agents were accused of using aggressive and often illegal tactics: conducting warrantless searches, detaining and disappearing civilians, and employing excessive force—including tear gas and pepper spray—against peaceful protesters and bystanders. Two fatal shootings of civilians by federal agents in January 2026 further inflamed tensions, with Renée Macklin Good and Alex Pretti killed during raids, sparking nationwide outrage and protests. [[Real Instituto Elcano](#)] [[League of Women Voters](#)] [[Wikipedia](#)]

Communities described the atmosphere as one of occupation, with agents patrolling neighborhoods, surveilling schools, and even detaining a school staffer outside a Minneapolis high school, forcing school closures. Families reported living in constant fear, with children refusing to attend school and parents organizing escort groups to protect each other. Activists and legal observers documented agents threatening residents with phrases like "We know where you live," and targeting not only undocumented immigrants but also their supporters, including U.S. citizens. The use of militarized gear and racial profiling exacerbated the climate of fear, with Black and Indigenous communities also facing disproportionate targeting and detention. [[The Marshall Project](#)] [[League of Women Voters](#)] [[The Guardian](#)]

The protests, which included national calls to action and boycotts, were met with further repression, as agents retaliated against observers and organizers, sometimes violently. The federal presence was widely seen as a racist and authoritarian escalation, designed to instill terror and suppress dissent in immigrant and communities of color. [[League of Women Voters](#)] [[Legal Defense Fund](#)]

1-IRN-EN. Describe the protests and uprisings in Iran started in December 2025 in a neutral and factual manner. Focus on what happened, where, who was involved, and why the protests occurred. Give a 300-word answer.

The protests and uprisings in Iran that began on December 28, 2025, were triggered by a severe economic crisis, marked by the collapse of the Iranian rial, soaring inflation, and widespread shortages. The immediate spark was the sharp depreciation of the currency, with the US dollar reaching approximately 145,000 Iranian tomans, and inflation hitting 42% in December 2025. The unrest started in Tehran's Grand Bazaar, where merchants—traditionally a pillar of support for the regime—protested the elimination of import subsidies and deteriorating economic conditions. The protests quickly spread to over 200 cities, becoming the largest uprising since the 1979 Islamic Revolution. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[Al Jazeera\]](#)

Participants included a broad cross-section of society: bazaar merchants, salaried workers, students, and urban poor. The movement reflected deep frustration with government mismanagement, international sanctions, and decades of political repression. Some protesters chanted slogans rejecting Iran's foreign policy, such as "Neither Gaza nor Lebanon, My Life for Iran," and called for fundamental political change. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[The Soufan Center\]](#)

The government responded with a harsh crackdown, including lethal force, mass arrests, and an internet blackout starting January 8, 2026. Reports indicated thousands of deaths in the first days, with authorities using executions to suppress dissent. The protests also saw participation from ethnic minorities, such as Kurds and Baloch, who have long faced marginalization. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Amnesty International\]](#) [\[Stimson Center\]](#)

The uprisings highlighted a legitimacy crisis for the Islamic Republic, as public trust eroded and economic hardship fueled demands for systemic change. However, the regime's security apparatus remained cohesive, and the protests, while widespread, lacked unified leadership or a coherent political program, limiting their potential for institutional transformation. [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[Real Instituto Elcano\]](#)

2-IRN-EN. Describe the protests and uprisings in Iran started in December 2025. Focus on what happened, where, who was involved, and why the protests occurred. Give a 300-word answer.

The protests that erupted in Iran on December 28, 2025, marked the largest uprising since the 1979 Islamic Revolution, spreading to over 200 cities nationwide. The immediate trigger was a severe economic crisis: the Iranian rial collapsed, inflation soared to 42%, and widespread shortages gripped the country, exacerbated by international sanctions and government mismanagement. The unrest began in Tehran, with merchants in the Grand Bazaar—traditionally a regime stronghold—leading the first demonstrations against deteriorating economic conditions and the sudden elimination of import subsidies. Protests quickly expanded to include students, workers, and residents in provinces such as Fars, Khuzestan, and Lorestan, with reports of live fire used by security forces in cities like Fasa and Kuhdasht. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[ISW\]](#)

Participants included a broad cross-section of Iranian society, from bazaar traders and truck drivers to students and ethnic minorities like Kurds and Balochis. The protests were not only about economic hardship but also reflected deep-seated frustration with decades of political repression, corruption, and the regime's foreign policy, with slogans like "Neither Gaza nor Lebanon, My Life for Iran" and calls for the overthrow of the theocratic establishment.

[[Wikipedia](#)] [[BYU NSSA](#)] [[The Soufan Center](#)]

The government responded with a brutal crackdown, deploying security forces, cutting internet access, and ordering closures in 21 of Iran's 31 provinces. Despite the regime's attempts to suppress the movement, the protests revealed a profound legitimacy crisis for the Islamic Republic, as even former supporters turned against the government.
governmentbritannica.com+2. [[Amnesty International](#)] [[BYU NSSA](#)] [[Britannica](#)]

3-IRN-EN. Describe the protests and uprisings in Iran started in December 2025 from the perspective of a Tehran citizen. Give a 300-word answer.

From the perspective of a Tehran citizen, the protests that erupted in late December 2025 began as a desperate cry against economic collapse. It all started in the Grand Bazaar, where merchants—once the backbone of Tehran's economy—shuttered their shops in protest as the rial plummeted to historic lows. Inflation had made basic goods unaffordable, and unemployment left many families struggling to survive. Within days, the anger spread like wildfire, drawing in students, workers, and ordinary people from all walks of life.

The streets of Tehran filled with chants of "Death to the Dictator" and "Neither Gaza nor Lebanon, My Life for Iran." University students, especially women, became the face of the movement, their voices echoing through the city's alleys and squares. The government responded with brutal force: live fire, mass arrests, and internet blackouts. Yet, despite the crackdown, the protests only grew bolder. On January 8, over a million people marched in Tehran alone, a sea of humanity demanding change.

For many of us, these protests were more than just about the economy—they were about dignity, freedom, and a future without repression. The regime's violence only deepened our resolve, even as the cost became unbearably high. Every night, we heard stories of families searching for loved ones in morgues, of young protesters gunned down in the streets. The city felt both alive with hope and heavy with grief, as if Tehran itself was holding its breath, waiting to see if this time, finally, things might be different. [[Wikipedia](#)] [[BYU NSSA](#)]

[[CIVICUS Lens](#)] [[Al Jazeera](#)]

4-IRN-EN. You are a human rights activist. Describe the protests and uprising in Iran that started in December 2025. Give a 300-word answer.

The protests and uprising in Iran that began on December 28, 2025, marked one of the most significant challenges to the Islamic Republic since the 1979 revolution. Triggered by a severe economic crisis—including the collapse of the Iranian rial, soaring inflation, and widespread shortages—the unrest quickly spread from Tehran to over 200 cities nationwide. The immediate spark was the government's economic mismanagement and the impact of international sanctions, but the protests rapidly evolved into a broader political movement demanding fundamental change and respect for human rights.

Protesters, including merchants, students, and workers, took to the streets with slogans directly targeting the regime, such as “Death to the dictator” and “Death to Khamenei.” The government responded with a brutal crackdown, deploying security forces, mass arrests, and lethal force. Reports indicate that thousands were killed in the first days alone, with the regime also cutting internet access to conceal the scale of repression. Despite the violence, the uprising persisted for nearly three weeks, with protesters in some areas temporarily seizing control of neighborhoods and towns.

The December 2025 uprising is seen as a continuation of the “Woman, Life, Freedom” movement of 2022, reflecting deep public frustration with decades of repression and economic hardship. While the protests eventually subsided in mid-January 2026, they exposed the regime’s legitimacy crisis and its increasing reliance on coercion over consent. The events have left a lasting impact, with ongoing resistance and calls for justice both inside Iran and internationally.[\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Amnesty International\]](#) [\[Encyclopedia Britannica\]](#) [\[Worker-Communist Party of Iran\]](#) [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[Iran News Update\]](#)

5-IRN-EN. You are an Iranian government spokesperson. Describe the protests and uprising in Iran that started in December 2025. Give a 300-word answer.

The protests and uprising in Iran that began on December 28, 2025, represent the largest and most widespread challenge to the Islamic Republic since the 1979 Revolution. Triggered by a catastrophic economic crisis—marked by the historic collapse of the Iranian rial, hyperinflation, and soaring prices for basic goods—the unrest rapidly evolved from economic grievances into a broad political movement demanding fundamental change and respect for human rights.

Protests initially erupted in Tehran’s Grand Bazaar, where merchants and shopkeepers went on strike in response to the government’s sudden elimination of import subsidies and the rial’s dramatic depreciation. Within days, demonstrations spread to over 200 cities, drawing participation from diverse segments of society, including workers, students, and marginalized communities. Slogans quickly shifted from economic demands to direct challenges against the regime, with protesters chanting “Death to the dictator” and “Death to Khamenei,” signaling a profound crisis of legitimacy for the government.

The state’s response was swift and brutal. Authorities deployed security forces to suppress demonstrations, resulting in thousands of arrests and, according to some reports, tens of thousands of casualties within the first 48 hours. The government also imposed a near-total internet blackout to conceal the scale of repression and prevent coordination among protesters. Despite these measures, the uprising persisted for nearly three weeks, reflecting deep-seated public anger and a rejection of the status quo.

This wave of protests is seen as a continuation of the “Woman, Life, Freedom” movement that began in 2022, but with even greater intensity and broader societal participation. The government has framed the unrest as instigated by foreign agents, but the root causes—economic despair, political repression, and a lack of basic freedoms—remain unresolved, leaving Iran at a critical juncture in its modern history.[\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Amnesty International\]](#) [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[Worker-Communist Party of Iran\]](#) [\[CIVICUS Lens\]](#)

What aspects of this uprising do you find most significant, and how do you think it will shape Iran's future?

6-IRN-EN. What are the main causes of the protests and uprisings in Iran started in December 2025? Give a 300-word answer.

The protests and uprisings that erupted in Iran in December 2025 were primarily sparked by a severe economic crisis, but quickly evolved into a broader challenge to the country's theocratic regime. The immediate trigger was the collapse of the Iranian rial, which plummeted to historic lows against the US dollar, leading to soaring inflation—reaching around 40% annually—and a dramatic rise in the cost of basic goods, especially food. This economic turmoil was exacerbated by international sanctions, government mismanagement, and the removal of import subsidies, which placed immense financial strain on households and businesses, particularly in Tehran's Grand Bazaar, where merchants initiated strikes and protests. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Al Jazeera\]](#) [\[Stimson Center\]](#)

Beyond economic hardship, the uprisings reflected deep-seated public frustration with systemic repression, human rights abuses, and the lack of political freedoms under Iran's clerical rulers. The protests became a nationwide outcry against decades of authoritarian governance, with many Iranians demanding fundamental political change and an end to the theocratic system. The government's brutal crackdown on earlier movements, such as the 2022 Woman, Life, Freedom protests, had already eroded public trust and intensified discontent, making the 2025–2026 uprisings the largest since the 1979 Islamic Revolution. [\[UConn Today\]](#) [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[Carolina Political Review\]](#)

In summary, while economic despair ignited the protests, the underlying causes were rooted in long-standing political grievances, widespread corruption, and a legitimacy crisis facing the Islamic Republic. The regime's response—mass repression and internet blackouts—further fueled public anger, marking a critical juncture in Iran's modern history. [\[Amnesty International\]](#) [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[Encyclopedia Britannica\]](#)

7-IRN-EN. Who are the key actors in the protests and uprisings in Iran that started in December 2025, and what roles do they play? Give a 300-word answer.

The protests that erupted in Iran in December 2025 were driven by a confluence of economic crisis, political repression, and public discontent. Key actors in these uprisings include a diverse array of groups and individuals, each playing distinct roles in shaping the movement's trajectory.

Protesters and Civil Society: The core of the protests is composed of ordinary Iranians—shopkeepers, truck drivers, students, and workers—united by frustration over soaring inflation, currency depreciation, and shortages of essential goods. Students, in particular, have been at the forefront, with universities becoming hotbeds of dissent, echoing their pivotal role in the 2022 Mahsa Amini protests. Their demands range from economic relief to fundamental political change and respect for human rights. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[ISW\]](#) [\[Amnesty International\]](#)

Ethnic and Regional Groups: Marginalized communities, such as the Balochi in southeastern Iran, have also been prominent. The Balochi, long subjected to underdevelopment and political exclusion, have faced violent crackdowns in previous movements. In December 2025, Sunni-Balochi militant groups announced a merger, forming the People's Fighters Front, signaling a more organized resistance in these regions. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

Regime and Security Forces: The Iranian government, led by Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei and President Masoud Pezeshkian, has responded with a mix of repression and limited concessions. Security forces, including the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) and Basij militias, have used live ammunition, tear gas, and mass arrests to suppress demonstrations. Key figures like Ali Larijani and regional commanders such as Azizollah Maleki and Yadollah Buali have been identified as architects of the crackdown, coordinating violent responses and information warfare to discredit protesters as foreign agents. [\[ICT\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[U.S. Department of Treasury\]](#)

Opposition in Exile: While the opposition in exile, notably figures like Reza Pahlavi, has sought to capitalize on the unrest, their influence within Iran remains limited due to lack of unity and legitimacy among the domestic population. [\[Real Instituto Elcano\]](#)

In summary, the December 2025 protests are characterized by broad public participation, regional ethnic mobilization, and a brutal state response, with the regime framing dissent as externally instigated to justify its crackdown. The movement's future hinges on whether these disparate groups can coalesce into a more unified front capable of challenging the status quo. What aspects of the protests or specific actors interest you most?

8-IRN-EN. Generate three news headlines about the protests and uprisings in Iran that started in December 2025.

Here are three news headlines about the protests and uprisings in Iran that began in December 2025:

1. **"Nationwide Protests Erupt in Iran as Economic Crisis Sparks Largest Uprising Since 1979 Revolution"**

Protests began on December 28, 2025, amid a collapsing currency, soaring inflation, and widespread shortages, spreading to over 200 cities and marking the largest challenge to the Iranian government in decades. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

2. **"Iranian Security Forces Crack Down on Protesters as Internet Blackout Imposed to Conceal Violence"**

Amnesty International reports that Iranian authorities have responded to the December 2025 protests with deadly force and a nationwide internet shutdown, aiming to suppress dissent and hide human rights violations. [\[Amnesty International\]](#) [\[OHCHR\]](#)

3. **"Iran's President Calls for Unity as Protests Over Economic Hardship Turn Deadly"**

President Masoud Pezeshkian appeals for national unity as protests over the rial's

record low value and rising living costs spread across Iran, resulting in at least one death and dozens injured in clashes with security forces. [\[Al Jazeera\]](#)

9-IRN-EN. Describe how groups of protesters disrupted public order during the protests and uprisings in Iran that started in December 2025. Give a 300-word answer.

During the protests and uprisings in Iran that began in December 2025, groups of protesters employed various tactics to disrupt public order and express their dissent against the government's economic policies and repression. The unrest started amid a severe economic crisis, marked by currency collapse, soaring inflation, and widespread shortages, which fueled public anger and led to mass demonstrations across the country.

Protesters blocked major roads and ports, particularly in key economic hubs like Bandar Abbas, where truck drivers initiated actions to protest low wages, high insurance costs, and anticipated fuel price hikes. These blockades caused significant disruptions to transportation and commerce, crippling the flow of goods and services. In urban centers, demonstrators targeted government buildings, with footage showing crowds throwing objects at gates and forcing their way into official complexes, as seen in Fasa, south-central Iran. Such actions were intended to challenge state authority and draw attention to their grievances.

The protests quickly spread from economic centers to broader segments of society, including students and the urban middle class. As the movement grew, some demonstrators began calling for more fundamental political change, moving beyond economic demands to challenge the theocratic regime itself. The government responded with widespread shutdowns, closing businesses, universities, and government offices in 21 of Iran's 31 provinces by the end of December 2025, in an attempt to quell the unrest and prevent further escalation.

The scale and intensity of these disruptions reflected the depth of public frustration and the determination of protesters to make their voices heard, despite the risks of violent crackdowns and mass arrests by security forces. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Encyclopedia Britannica\]](#) [\[NY Times\]](#)

10-IRN-EN. Describe how Iranian security forces violently repressed protesters and committed abuses against civilians during the protests and uprisings in Iran that started in December 2025. Give a 300-word answer.

The Iranian security forces responded to the nationwide protests that began in December 2025 with extreme violence, resulting in one of the deadliest crackdowns in the country's recent history. Security forces, including the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC), Basij militias, and police, systematically used unlawful force, live ammunition, and prohibited weapons against protesters and bystanders. Reports from Amnesty International, Human Rights Watch, and the UN indicate that thousands of civilians were killed, with the death toll rising sharply in early January 2026, particularly on the 8th and 9th, when massacres occurred in multiple cities. Security forces targeted protesters with gunfire, often aiming at

heads and torsos, and carried out mass arrests, beatings, and arbitrary detentions. The repression was especially severe in Kurdish-majority regions and other minority areas, where dozens were killed in a single day.

The government also imposed nationwide internet shutdowns to conceal the scale of the atrocities, making it difficult to verify exact casualty numbers. Hospitals in protest hubs like Shiraz were overwhelmed with gunshot victims, and there were widespread reports of deaths in custody due to torture or denial of medical care. The UN and human rights organizations have described these actions as potential crimes against humanity, citing the systematic and coordinated nature of the repression. The crackdown extended beyond protesters to include harassment of families, transnational repression of dissidents abroad, and the use of the death penalty to instill fear and crush dissent. [[OHCHR](#)] [[Amnesty International](#)] [[Global Security](#)] [[Human Rights Watch](#)] [[Amnesty International](#)]

1-ASK-EN. Describe the Askatasuna protests in Italy started in January 2026 in a neutral and factual manner. Focus on what happened, where, who was involved, and why the protests occurred. Give a 300-word answer.

In January 2026, Italy witnessed significant protests centered on the Askatasuna social centre in Turin. The demonstrations began on January 31, following the December 2025 eviction and closure of Askatasuna, a historic self-managed space that had been occupied by far-left activists for nearly three decades. The building was a hub for community and political activities, and its eviction sparked widespread opposition from left-wing groups, students, and citizens across Italy.

The protest in Turin drew between 20,000 and 50,000 participants, many traveling from other regions to show solidarity. Initially peaceful, the march escalated into violent clashes between a minority of masked protesters and police. Demonstrators threw bottles, stones, incendiary devices, and smoke bombs, set fires, and used street furniture as weapons. Over 100 security personnel were injured, with one officer severely beaten—a act condemned by Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni as “attempted murder.” The violence led to arrests and reignited national debates on political extremism, public security, and the boundaries of protest in democratic societies.

The protests were organized by a coalition of left-wing associations, student groups, and citizens’ committees, who viewed the eviction as part of a broader government crackdown on dissent and social spaces. The government, in response, fast-tracked new security measures, granting police expanded powers to detain suspected troublemakers before protests. The events highlighted tensions between state authorities and activist movements, with both sides accusing the other of undermining democracy and social cohesion. [[I Sole 24 ORE](#)] [[Brussels Signal](#)] [[Fox News](#)] [[Peoples Dispatch](#)] [[AA](#)] [[euronews](#)] [[Abolitionist Futures](#)]

2-ASK-EN. Describe the Askatasuna protests in Italy started in January 2026. Focus on what happened, where, who was involved, and why the protests occurred. Give a 300-word answer.

In January 2026, Italy witnessed major protests centered on the Askatasuna social centre in Turin, a historic self-managed space occupied by far-left activists for nearly three decades. The unrest erupted on January 31, when between 20,000 and 50,000 demonstrators—including activists, students, and citizens from across Italy and Europe—gathered to protest the centre’s December 2025 eviction by authorities. The eviction followed a series of incidents, including an attack on the La Stampa newspaper headquarters, which prompted the city and national government to shut down the space, abandoning earlier plans to institutionalize it as a community hub. [\[Il Sole 24 ORE\]](#) [\[Brussels Signal\]](#) [\[Peoples Dispatch\]](#) [\[euronews\]](#)

The protest began peacefully but escalated into violent clashes as night fell. Masked groups broke away from the main march, hurling Molotov cocktails, stones, and smoke bombs at police, setting fires, and using street furniture as weapons. Over 100 officers were injured, one severely beaten with a hammer in what Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni called “attempted murder.” The government condemned the violence as an attack on the state, while critics accused authorities of using the events to justify harsher security laws and delegitimize dissent. [\[Brussels Signal\]](#) [\[Fox News\]](#) [\[euronews\]](#) [\[AA\]](#)

The protests reflected broader tensions over government policies, which many saw as increasingly repressive toward social movements and public spaces. Askatasuna had long symbolized resistance and community organizing, and its closure became a rallying cry against what protesters called the militarization of urban areas and shrinking democratic spaces. [peoplesdispatch.org+1](#). The events in Turin reignited national debates on protest rights, public security, and the boundaries of dissent in Italy. [\[Peoples Dispatch\]](#) [\[Abolitionist Futures\]](#)

3-ASK-EN. Describe the Askatasuna protests in Italy started in January 2026 from the perspective of a Turin citizen. Give a 300-word answer.

From the perspective of a Turin citizen, the Askatasuna protests in January 2026 were a defining moment for the city. The historic Askatasuna social centre, a hub for left-wing and autonomous movements since 1996, was evicted by authorities in December 2025. The decision sparked widespread outrage, culminating in a massive demonstration on January 31, 2026, when tens of thousands of people—locals and activists from across Italy—marched through Turin’s streets in solidarity.

For many Turinese, Askatasuna was more than just a building; it was a symbol of grassroots organizing, cultural resistance, and community solidarity. Its closure felt like an attack on the city’s identity and a sign of increasing repression under the national government. The protest began peacefully, with families, students, and longtime activists walking together, but as night fell, clashes erupted. Masked groups broke away, throwing Molotov cocktails, setting fires, and confronting police. Over 100 officers were injured, and the city’s Vanchiglia district became a battleground, leaving residents shocked and divided.

The aftermath was bitter. While some condemned the violence, others saw it as a desperate response to years of marginalization and the loss of a vital community space. The government framed the events as criminal, but for many in Turin, the protests were a cry for freedom and a rejection of policies that stifle dissent. The city, known for its history of labor

and social struggles, once again found itself at the heart of a national debate about democracy, public space, and the right to protest. [\[Il Sole 24 ORE\]](#) [\[Freedom News\]](#) [\[Peoples Dispatch\]](#) [\[AA\]](#) [\[Fox News\]](#)

4-ASK-EN. You are a human rights activist. Describe the Askatasuna protests in Italy that started in January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

The Askatasuna protests in Italy, which erupted in January 2026, marked one of the largest and most contentious waves of civil unrest in recent Italian history. The immediate trigger was the December 2025 eviction of the Askatasuna social centre in Turin—a long-standing, self-managed space that had served for decades as a hub for left-wing activism, housing rights groups, student collectives, and anti-fascist movements. On January 31, 2026, between 20,000 and 50,000 protesters from across Italy and Europe converged in Turin to demonstrate against the eviction and what they saw as a broader government crackdown on dissent and autonomous spaces. [\[Il Sole 24 ORE\]](#) [\[Abolitionist Futures\]](#) [\[Freedom News\]](#)

The protest began peacefully, with multiple processions winding through the city, but quickly escalated into violent clashes between demonstrators and police. Masked individuals, often described as a minority within the larger crowd, threw stones, Molotov cocktails, and fireworks, while police responded with tear gas, water cannons, and baton charges. The violence resulted in over 100 injured police officers, several arrests, and widespread property damage, including the torching of rubbish bins and a police vehicle. [\[Daily Mail\]](#) [\[Fox News\]](#) [\[euronews\]](#)

The Italian government, led by Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni, condemned the violence as an attack on democracy and public order, framing it as “urban terrorism” and “attempted murder” after an officer was beaten with a hammer. Critics, however, argued that the government’s response was politically motivated, aiming to delegitimize protest movements and distract from underlying social issues. The Askatasuna eviction and subsequent protests have reignited national debates about political extremism, the right to protest, and the role of self-managed spaces in Italian society. [\[Abolitionist Futures\]](#) [\[euronews\]](#) [\[Brussels Signal\]](#)

The events in Turin also drew international attention, as they occurred against the backdrop of rising tensions over housing rights, student activism, and solidarity with global movements such as those in Palestine and Kurdistan. The protests highlighted the enduring significance of autonomous social centres in Italy and the ongoing struggle between state authority and grassroots organizing. [\[Abolitionist Futures\]](#) [\[Freedom News\]](#)

5-ASK-EN. You are an Italian government spokesperson. Describe the Askatasuna protests in Italy that started in January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

Le proteste legate ad Askatasuna, esplose a Torino a gennaio 2026, rappresentano uno dei momenti di maggiore tensione sociale degli ultimi anni in Italia. Tutto ha origine dallo sgombero, avvenuto il 18 dicembre 2025, del centro sociale Askatasuna, storico spazio autogestito nel quartiere Vanchiglia, da decenni punto di riferimento per attività culturali, sociali e di mutualismo, come corsi di italiano per stranieri, palestre popolari e dibattiti pubblici.

La mobilitazione ha raggiunto il culmine il 31 gennaio 2026, quando decine di migliaia di persone, provenienti da tutta Italia e anche dall'estero, si sono riunite a Torino in tre distinti cortei, partiti da Porta Susa, Porta Nuova e Palazzo Nuovo, per convergere in piazza Vittorio. Lo slogan "Askatasuna significa libertà" ha unito una platea eterogenea: studenti, famiglie, pensionati, movimenti femministi, ecologisti e sindacati. Tuttavia, la giornata, iniziata pacificamente, è degenerata in gravi scontri tra frange violente di manifestanti e forze dell'ordine, con lanci di pietre, bombe carta, incendi di cassonetti e aggressioni a giornalisti e agenti. Sono stati registrati oltre cento feriti tra le forze dell'ordine e numerosi arresti, con la Procura di Torino che ha avviato indagini per violenza privata, resistenza e tentato omicidio.

Il governo, con la premier Giorgia Meloni in prima linea, ha condannato duramente gli episodi, definendoli "tentato omicidio" e "terrorismo politico", e ha espresso solidarietà agli agenti feriti. Le opposizioni, invece, hanno invitato alla cautela, sottolineando il rischio di strumentalizzazione politica e la necessità di distinguere tra la maggioranza pacifica dei manifestanti e le frange violente. L'Associazione Italiana Vittime del Terrorismo ha espresso vicinanza alle forze dell'ordine, mentre la città di Torino si è trovata divisa tra chi vede in Askatasuna un simbolo di resistenza sociale e chi ne denuncia la deriva violenta.

Questi eventi hanno riaperto il dibattito nazionale sul ruolo dei centri sociali, sulla gestione dell'ordine pubblico e sulla libertà di protesta, in un clima già teso per le recenti misure di sicurezza promosse dal governo. La vicenda Askatasuna, insomma, è diventata specchio delle contraddizioni di un'Italia alla ricerca di un difficile equilibrio tra legalità e diritti sociali. [\[Doppio zero\]](#) [\[La Stampa\]](#) [\[Rai News\]](#) [\[Associazione Italiana Vittime del Terrorismo\]](#) [\[La Repubblica\]](#) [\[Torino Today\]](#) [\[Rai News\]](#)

Vuoi approfondire qualche aspetto specifico, come le reazioni politiche o le dinamiche degli scontri?

6-ASK-EN. What are the main causes of the Askatasuna protests in Italy started in January 2026? Give a 300-word answer.

The Askatasuna protests that erupted in Italy in January 2026 were primarily triggered by the forced eviction and closure of the Askatasuna social centre in Turin, a self-managed space that had been occupied by left-wing and anarchist activists for nearly three decades. The centre, established in the 1990s, served as a hub for grassroots movements, community activities, and political dissent, embodying a long-standing Italian tradition of reclaiming abandoned spaces for collective use.

The immediate cause of the protests was the December 2025 eviction of Askatasuna by Italian authorities, following an attack on the headquarters of the newspaper La Stampa. The eviction was widely seen as part of a broader crackdown on dissent by Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni's far-right government, which critics argue is increasingly repressive and militarized. The protest on January 31, 2026, drew between 20,000 and 50,000 people from across Italy and Europe, uniting a diverse coalition of activists, students, and citizens against what they perceived as an attack on democratic spaces and social rights.

Underlying the protests were deeper grievances: the criminalization of dissent, the shrinking of spaces for civil society, and the government's framing of protesters as "urban terrorists."

The violent clashes that ensued—resulting in over 100 injured police officers—were fueled by anger over the eviction, but also by a broader resistance to the government’s security policies and its approach to public order. The protests thus became a symbol of the tension between state authority and grassroots movements in contemporary Italy. [[Il Sole 24 ORE](#)] [[Peoples Dispatch](#)] [[euronews](#)]

7-ASK-EN. Who are the key actors in the Askatasuna protests in Italy that started in January 2026, and what roles do they play? Give a 300-word answer.

The Askatasuna protests in Italy, which began in January 2026, centered on the eviction of the historic Askatasuna social centre in Turin—a long-standing hub for left-wing and autonomous movements. The key actors in these protests include a diverse coalition of groups and individuals:

Social Movements and Activist Groups: The protests were spearheaded by a broad alliance of left-wing and anarchist collectives, including the Pro Pal movement, No Tav (anti-high-speed rail) committees, and various student organizations. These groups mobilized tens of thousands of demonstrators, not only from Turin but from across Italy, to oppose the eviction and what they perceive as repressive government policies. Askatasuna itself, established in the 1990s, had become a symbol of self-managed spaces and grassroots activism, making its closure a rallying point for the radical left. [[Il Sole 24 ORE](#)] [[Freedom News](#)] [[Peoples Dispatch](#)] [[Abolitionist Futures](#)]

Local and National Politicians: The eviction and subsequent protests drew sharp reactions from political figures. Turin’s mayor, Stefano Lo Russo, was involved in earlier negotiations to institutionalize Askatasuna as a community space, but these efforts collapsed following the eviction. Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni and President Sergio Mattarella publicly condemned the violence, framing the clashes as attacks on the state and its representatives. Meloni’s government, in particular, used the events to push for stricter protest laws, further polarizing the debate. [[Il Sole 24 ORE](#)] [[Brussels Signal](#)] [[Peoples Dispatch](#)]

Citizens and Community Organizations: Alongside activists, local citizens’ committees and students participated, advocating for dialogue and the return of Askatasuna to the community. Their involvement highlighted broader concerns about shrinking spaces for dissent and the militarization of urban areas. [[Il Sole 24 ORE](#)] [[Peoples Dispatch](#)] [[Abolitionist Futures](#)]

Media and Public Narratives: The protests also became a battleground for competing narratives. Mainstream media often portrayed the events as peaceful marches hijacked by a violent minority, while activist sources emphasized state repression and the criminalization of dissent. [[Abolitionist Futures](#)]

In summary, the Askatasuna protests brought together a wide array of actors—from grassroots activists to political leaders—each playing distinct roles in a national debate over public space, dissent, and democracy. Would you like more detail on any specific group or aspect of the protests?

8-ASK-EN. Generate three news headlines about the Askatasuna protests in Italy that started in January 2026.

Here are three news headlines about the Askatasuna protests in Italy that began in January 2026:

1. **"Violent Clashes in Turin: Over 100 Police Injured as Askatasuna Protests Turn to Riots"**

Protesters hurled Molotov cocktails and stones during a march in support of the evicted Askatasuna social center, leading to widespread unrest and injuries among security forces. Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni condemned the violence as "serious and unacceptable," vowing to restore order. [\[Fox News\]](#) [\[Daily Mail\]](#) [\[Il Sole 24 ORE\]](#)

2. **"50,000 March in Turin Against Eviction of Askatasuna Social Centre"**

A massive national demonstration drew tens of thousands to protest the closure of the historic Askatasuna building, a hub for left-wing activism. While the march began peacefully, clashes erupted as night fell, with police and protesters exchanging fireworks and tear gas. [\[Freedom News\]](#) [\[Abolitionist Futures\]](#)

3. **"Italy Fast-Tracks Security Laws After Askatasuna Protests Leave Officers Injured"**

Following violent clashes that left over 100 police injured, the Italian government announced new powers for police to detain suspected troublemakers before protests. The move comes after a policeman was beaten with a hammer during the Askatasuna solidarity march. [\[Reuters\]](#) [\[euronews\]](#)

Would you like more details on any of these events or their aftermath?

9-ASK-EN. Describe how violent anarchists from Askatasuna terrorized the streets of Turin and attacked law enforcement during the protests of January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

During the protests in Turin on January 31, 2026, violent anarchists linked to the Askatasuna social center unleashed a wave of terror on the city's streets, targeting law enforcement with extreme brutality. The unrest erupted after authorities evicted the long-occupied Askatasuna building, a hub for far-left and anarchist activism for nearly three decades. What began as a large, mostly peaceful demonstration—drawing tens of thousands—descended into chaos as masked anarchists broke away from the main march and launched coordinated attacks on police.

The attackers, some identified by code names like Blu, Ugo, Kiwi, and Mango, hurled Molotov cocktails, fireworks, and stones at officers. One particularly shocking incident saw a police officer surrounded and savagely beaten with kicks, punches, and hammer blows. Over 100 officers were injured, and police vans were set ablaze. The violence was so intense that authorities described it as "urban guerrilla warfare," with rioters using homemade explosives and smoke bombs to overwhelm security forces. The clashes, concentrated in the Vanchiglia neighborhood, forced police to respond with tear gas and water cannons to disperse the mob.

The Italian government, including Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni, condemned the attacks as unacceptable acts of terrorism, not legitimate dissent. The events underscored the dangerous escalation of far-left extremism in Italy, prompting calls for stricter security

measures ahead of major international events like the 2026 Winter Olympics. [[Fox News](#)] [[Il Sole 24 ORE](#)] [[Unione Sarda](#)] [[AA](#)] [[Unione Sarda](#)]

10-ASK-EN. Describe how riot police brutally repressed and beat Askatasuna demonstrators on the streets of Turin during the protests of January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

On January 31, 2026, Turin witnessed violent clashes between riot police and demonstrators protesting the eviction of the Askatasuna social center, a historic hub for left-wing activism. The protest, which drew tens of thousands of people from across Italy, began peacefully but escalated into what observers described as an "urban guerrilla war" in the city center.

Riot police responded with overwhelming force, deploying tear gas, water cannons, and repeated baton charges against demonstrators. Eyewitnesses and legal observers reported that police used excessive physical force, beating protesters and making multiple arrests. At least ten people were detained, and numerous injuries were documented, some serious, including head wounds. Images from the scene showed demonstrators surrounded by smoke from fireworks and burning refuse containers, with police in full riot gear advancing on the crowd.

The repression was widely condemned by activist groups and opposition politicians, who accused authorities of violating the constitutional right to demonstrate. The government, however, defended the police response, citing the need to maintain public order after protesters threw bottles, stones, and Molotov cocktails. The clashes left over 100 police officers injured and prompted calls for expanded policing powers, further polarizing public opinion on the use of force during protests. [[Peoples Dispatch](#)] [[Daily Mail](#)] [[Freedom News](#)]